

Chanel Athena Estrada
30MAY26
IT FDN 130 GP Sp 26
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Introduction

This document is intended to provide an overview and explain:

1. When to use a SQL View.
2. The differences and similarities between a view, function, and stored procedure.

Topic 1: When to use a SQL View

A SQL View is typically used in order to simplify complicated/complex joins and inquiries, duplicate the same query in multiple places or restrict access due to security for selected columns/rows/tables.

Topic 2: The differences and similarities between a View, Function, and Stored Procedure.

A View is ideal for simplifying data presentation as well as restricting access, and cannot change data. Functions are used for calculations and returning values or quantifying results, and cannot change data. Stored Procedures are utilized for complex operations and business logistics, and can change or modify the data.

All of these functions support organization by reducing code repetition.

Summary

This document generally outlines the superficial use of when a SQL View as well as the differences/similarities between a View, Function, and Stored Procedure.

Citations:

Root, Randal. (n.d.) Randal Root [Youtube Channel]. Youtube. Retrieved May 2026) from <https://www.youtube.com/@randalroot729>
Root, Randal (2026, May). Module06Notes. [PDF]. University of Washington.